

Northwind Robotics — Employee Handbook

Version 5.1 — effective 1 Feb 2026. This is a fictional document created for demonstration and testing only.

Section 1 — Onboarding

Welcome to Northwind Robotics. All new hires complete a structured onboarding program during their first two weeks. Onboarding covers workstation setup, benefits enrollment, and an introduction to the engineering and operations teams.

New employees are subject to a probationary period governed by policy code **HR-204**. Under policy **HR-204**, the probation period is **90 days** from the employee's start date. During this 90-day probation, either the employee or Northwind Robotics may end the employment relationship with shortened notice, and performance is reviewed at the 30-day and 60-day marks.

Onboarding buddies are assigned to every new hire to help them settle in. Questions about onboarding logistics should be directed to the People Operations team.

Section 2 — Time Off

Full-time employees at Northwind Robotics accrue **22 days of paid time off (PTO) per year**. In addition, employees receive **10 days of sick leave per year**, which is tracked separately from PTO.

Employees who resign must provide a **notice period of 30 days** before their final working day. Unused PTO may be carried into the next calendar year up to a **carryover cap of 5 days**; any PTO above the 5-day cap is forfeited at year end.

Section 3 — Remote Work

Northwind Robotics supports a hybrid working model. Eligible employees may work remotely for **up to 3 days per week**, with the remaining days spent in the office to support in-person collaboration.

Section 3 — Remote Work (continued)

To support home-based work, the company provides a **home-office stipend of \$400 per year**. The stipend may be used for ergonomic equipment, monitors, or other approved home-office supplies, and is reimbursed against submitted receipts.

Section 4 — Expenses

When traveling for business, employees may claim a **meal per-diem of \$75 per day**. Per-diem covers breakfast, lunch, and dinner and does not require itemized receipts.

Northwind Robotics issues company laptops to all employees. **Company laptops are refreshed every 3 years**, at which point the employee receives a new device and returns the old one to IT.

Expense reports must be submitted **within 14 days** of the expense being incurred. Reports submitted after the 14-day window may be delayed or denied.

Section 5 — Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to act with integrity, treat colleagues with respect, and avoid conflicts of interest. Harassment and discrimination of any kind are prohibited. Employees must protect confidential company and customer information at all times.

Northwind Robotics maintains a whistleblowing channel for reporting unethical or unlawful conduct. Concerns may be reported confidentially to the Ethics Office at ethics@northwind-robotics.example. Retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith is strictly prohibited.

Violations of this Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.